



Really Great Reading

Recommendations for Supporting Native Spanish Speakers

This resource provides ways to enhance *Countdown, Blast, and HD Word* to support your Native Spanish Speakers.

All Programs Recommendations | Countdown, Blast, and HD Word

Spanish Animations

Spanish support versions of Really Great Reading's Online English Animations

Throughout *Countdown, Blast, and HD Word*, Really Great Reading includes online video animations that introduce and review phonics concepts. We've taken many of these English animations and created supplemental Spanish support versions. These versions have Spanish translation with a target focus on English reading skills. The goal of the Spanish animations is to increase comprehension, through the use of the native language, and for students to leverage their background knowledge in Spanish to enhance their learning in English. Spanish animations can be found in the *Supplemental Resources* tab of *Countdown, Blast, and HD Word Online*, under *Spanish Resources*.

RECOMMENDATIONS:

- Use the Spanish Supports Scope and Sequence to guide you on which resources are available per skills taught. Specific teacher recommendations and language considerations are also provided within the Scope and Sequence.
- If the whole class needs additional support, we recommend playing the Spanish animations that teach the English skill of focus, in place of the English animation.
- If a small group of individuals needs additional support we recommend playing the Spanish animations, of the skill of focus, in a small group setting even if the student has already seen or will see the animation in English via whole group.

Current Spanish Support Animations:

- Routine Skill Animations
- Heart Word Animations
- Letter Articulation Animations
- Instructional Focus Skill Animations

Our Spanish animations fall under four specific categories.

Nonsense Words

Research indicates that emerging bilingual students strive to give meaning to new words in the language they are learning. Nonsense words like "jat" are not real English words but are used during decoding practice. Due to this being a common practice for decoding skills in English, we recommend having your student first watch the explanation of What is a Nonsense Word? for context before attempting to practice decoding words. We also suggest, using the EL/ Español online teacher presentations for whole group practice lessons 3 and 4.

Each nonsense word to be decoded, is accompanied by a visual which appears, reminding the student that there is no meaning attached to the specific word being read.

RECOMMENDATIONS:

- **For struggling emergent readers:** Omit or skip nonsense word practice activities; utilize all the real word examples.
- **Emergent Bilinguals:** Explicitly teach that the focus is only on identifying letters to sounds and that these nonsense words do not have any meaning in English.

Sentences for Dictation

Dictation sentences help students practice spelling each word in a sentence, one by one. Most of the words in the sentences are decodable. That means they only contain the concepts students have learned up to and including that particular unit, so students should be able to spell the words up to and including the last unit they were taught. There are also some high-frequency words in each sentence which students may or may not have mastered already. If students cannot spell a non-decodable high-frequency word, you may help them with that word by providing the letter(s) the student cannot spell independently.

RECOMMENDATION:

Utilize the Sentences for Dictation PDFs found in Supplemental Resources. There are three sentences prepared for each unit.

Recommended Steps:

1. Teacher says sentence/phrase.
2. Students repeat sentence/phrase.
3. Chorally say the phrase and count the number of words.
4. Chorally say the phrase and draw a line for each word.
5. Touch and say each word in the phrase.
6. Spell each word on the line. Use the Spell it! routine to break down words if necessary.

Note: *Countdown's* Sentences for Dictation begin at Unit 19. If you want to use the routine for earlier units, we recommend using the phrases presented in the Phrase Reading activity in Units 10-18.

Countdown Recommendations

Sound Stories

Really Great Reading uses Sound Stories to introduce phonemes to students. Sound Stories are alliterative stories that teachers have the option to show via an animation or read aloud to students. Each story is focused on one target sound. After listening to the story, students participate by choosing words that start with the targeted sound.

The online animations provide visuals and encourage students to listen for key words beginning with the target phoneme. It is important for your emergent bilingual to understand the purpose of the Sound Story activity. They need to understand that the objective of this activity is to listen for the beginning sound of focus and answer accordingly. To support this understanding, there are three initial Spanish Sound

Stories provided, which can be played. Our Spanish Sound Stories will further support the understanding of the activity objective, so that your English learner students, can more actively participate and relate to English letter sound stories.

RECOMMENDATIONS:

Play the Spanish Sound Story Animations ideally before playing the English ones. Our Spanish Sound Stories will reiterate the skill for listening for the beginning sound of each focus letter.

The Spanish Sound Stories provided, are purposely letters and sounds shared by both languages. This is done to further enable purpose and meaning, as well as to enable crosslinguistic transfer.

Countdown & Blast Recommendations

Heart Word Generator

In *Countdown* and *Blast*, we refer to high-frequency words like the words **said**, **you**, **and** as Heart Words. These Heart Words are words that students often see in texts and usually have a part of the word that does not follow the phonics rules students have been taught. Thus, the word is phonetically irregular, and students need to know part of the word by heart.

English Heart Words can sometimes be tricky for Native Spanish speakers because the words don't always have a literal meaning from one language to the other. Therefore, we suggest that you use the Heart Word Generator tool to adjust the weekly Heart Words to meet the needs of your students. We also recommend playing the "What is a Heart Word" Spanish animation to provide context for the purpose and function of Heart Words in English.

RECOMMENDATIONS:

If you are teaching a core English reading program: adjust the Heart Word Generator to match the high-frequency words in your core program that week.

If you are teaching a core Spanish reading program: adjust the Heart Word Generator to make the high-frequency words the same, but in English, as your core Spanish program; this will help students build the cross-linguistic transfer.

- **Example:** Spanish high-frequency word might be **veo**; in the Heart Word Generator that week, you can adjust one the Heart Words to be **see**.

HD Word Recommendations

Oral Reading Fluency

Replace with Decodable Passages

In *HD Word*, teachers lead the class through Oral Reading Fluency lessons in Lesson 1 of each unit. The passages are uncontrolled text, meaning they have a variety of words and syllable types that your students may not have yet learned. This is an activity we recommend for Native English Speakers, but it may be frustrating for emerging English Learners.

Therefore, we recommend that you replace the Oral Reading Fluency practice passages with the *HD Word* Decodable Passages. The *HD Word* Decodable Passages are controlled texts where students will only practice the decoding skills they've been introduced to in the current and previous units. The instructions and passages are found in the Supplemental Resources tab of *HD Word Online* under *PDF Resources* and *HD Word Passages*.

RECOMMENDATIONS:

HD Word Book 1 Timeframe – utilize the *HD Word* Decodable Passages that review the phonics concepts you taught in the current or previous units.

- **Example:** In Unit 3 of *HD Word*, you teach trigraphs and 3-sound blends. During Unit 4, replace the Lesson 1 Oral Reading Fluency passage with the Unit 3 Trigraph and 3-Sound Blends Decodable passage.

HD Word Book 2 Timeframe – utilize the original *HD Word* Oral Reading Fluency lessons, beginning in Lesson 1 of *HD Word*.